# Respirator Mask

Category: **Safety & PPE** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 1 labs

**Covers these lab items:** Chemical Mask

## What it is used for

A chemical respirator helps reduce inhalation exposure when equipped with the correct approved filter or cartridge for the identified hazard. Select it through the workplace respiratory protection program and follow fit-testing and manufacturer instructions.

## How to use

1. Identify the chemical hazard and consult the safety data sheet and risk assessment.
2. Select a respirator and cartridge approved for the specific contaminant and exposure conditions.
3. Inspect the facepiece, straps, valves, seals, and cartridge expiry date before use.
4. Fit the respirator according to manufacturer instructions and perform the required user seal check.
5. Enter the work area only after confirming suitable protection and required authorization.
6. Leave the area if breathing becomes difficult, leakage occurs, or contamination is suspected.
7. Remove the respirator safely, clean reusable parts as directed, and store it properly.

## ⚠ Safety

- A respirator does not protect against every chemical or oxygen-deficient atmosphere.
- Do not use a cartridge beyond its approved service life or for an unknown hazard.
- Use fit testing and medical clearance where required by the respiratory protection program.
- For unknown, immediately dangerous, or oxygen-deficient atmospheres, do not enter without a trained response team and appropriate supplied-air equipment.

## Care & storage

- Replace filters and cartridges according to the approved schedule and store the respirator sealed in a clean, dry place.

*Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.*